Unit 2

Achieving Equality



Learning Objectives

- Know the meanings of prejudice and stereotypes
- Understand discrimination and inequality
- Become aware of the negative consequences of discrimination

The society that we live in comprises people from various social groups who are different in many ways. Since we believe in 'Unity in Diversity', we should have been living peacefully with one another irrespective of those differences. Often, we see that diversity is not accepted, and people show attitudes of hostility towards those who are 'different' from them. They form opinions about the other groups and this often leads to tension in the society. Such 'opinions' are often 'prejudiced'.

1. Prejudice

Prejudice means to judge other people in a negative or inferior manner, without knowing much about them. It happens when people have false belief and ideas.

Prejudice ⟶ Pre + Judge

The word 'prejudice' refers to prejudgement. Prejudices can be based on many things like people's religious beliefs, the region they come from, the colour of their skin, language, their accent or the clothes they wear. The types of prejudice are gender prejudice, racial prejudice, class prejudice, disability prejudice and so on.

For example, urban people are more civilised than rural people in attitudes and behaviour, is one such prejudice.

1.1 Causes for Prejudice

Some common social factors that contributes to the rise of prejudice are

1. Socialisation
2. Conforming behaviours
3. Economic benefits